and two RCL guns while Foot Hill had a section of 3-inch mortars. An artillery forward observer, Second Lieutenant S. D. Goswami, was positioned with the Gorkhas at Gun Hill, and he was directing retaliatory fire from the Indian guns positioned at High Ground further in depth. Gun Hill was under the command of Captain P. L. Kher.

Twice in the next couple of hours, 600 Chinese soldiers tried to advance in waves, only to be stopped by the Indian artillery and the small arms fire of the Gorkhas, forcing the advancing Chinese to seek cover where they were. At 9 a.m., the Chinese launched a fresh attack with 500 more soldiers. As they moved slowly forward under covering MMG fire, their ranks started to swell as troops from the earlier two attacks began to join them. The nerve-racking phenomenon of the Chinese numbers doubling as they advanced was enough to shake the confidence of any troops. However, Kher was keeping the spirits of his men up, seemingly present everywhere.

Meanwhile, to get a better view of the Chinese, Goswami had crawled forward from where he was directing the lone Indian battery. At this point, both Kher and Goswami were wounded. While Kher was pulled back and evacuated from the post by his men, no one could get to the artillery officer who was trapped in the no-man’s land between the defenders and the attackers.

With the two officers incapacitated, Naib Subedar Teghbahadur Gurung assumed command of Bravo Company. The JCO kept moving from one position to another, encouraging the men to keep fighting. It was but a matter of time before a Chinese MMG burst hit him in the chest. Even though he was dying, he refused to be evacuated.

Orders to withdraw from the post were received shortly thereafter. Apart from Gurung, twelve Gorkhas were dead while Kher and another eleven men were wounded. The Gorkhas broke contact and pulled out and the Chinese overran the picket, but abandoned it shortly thereafter. Later in the evening another reserve platoon of the Gorkhas reoccupied the post. The next day, the Chinese once again bombarded the picket intermittently, but failed to launch an attack. Once again orders were received in the evening of 19 November to abandon Gurung Hill. At 5 a.m. on 20 November, the Gorkhas pulled out again. The Chinese, however, never occupied the post.

The second Gorkha picket on the Gurung Hill feature overlooked the Spanggur Gap. On 19 November, at the base of Trench Hill, the Chinese brought up their tanks briefly, but at no stage did they try and rush through